

Geography Test -1

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Q1. Which of the following statements is NOT correct regarding laterite soil?

- (A) Red laterite soils in Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh and Kerala are more suitable for crops like cashew nut.
- (B) They are generally rich in humus.
- (C) This soil is very useful for growing tea and coffee.
- (D) The laterite soil develops in areas with high temperature and heavy rainfall.

Solution: Red laterite soils in Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh and Kerala are more suitable for crops like cashew nut. Laterite soil - It is rich in iron and aluminium. Features - Deficient in organic matter, phosphate, nitrogen and calcium but abundant in iron oxide and potash, forms due to the alternation of dry and wet periods, Because of leaching these soils have an acidic quality. Suitable for - Banana, vegetables, tapioca, yams, pineapple, pepper, fruit trees etc.

Q2. What is the sex ratio of India as per 2011 census?

- (A) 843 females per 1000 males
- (B) 943 females per 1000 males
- (C) 643 females per 1000 males
- (D) 743 females per 1000 males

Solution: 943 females per 1000 males. Sex ratio is defined as the number of females per 1000 males. The lowest sex ratio in India is in Haryana (877) and the highest sex ratio is in Kerala (1084). Among UTs, Puducherry has the highest sex ratio of 1037 while Daman and Diu has the lowest sex ratio (618).

Q3. The northern plains of India are formed up of which soil?

- (A) Alluvial
- (B) Peaty
- (C) Black
- (D) Laterite

Solution: Alluvial soils are deposited by running water. It requires the least water due to its high porosity. Peat Soil is formed by the partial decomposition of organic matter. Black Soil (Regur soil) is formed by weathering of lava rocks and these soils are very fertile. Laterite Soil is rich in aluminum and iron. It is formed in wet and hot tropical areas. This is more common in the Eastern and Western Ghats.

Q4. Which of the following straits is located between the Java Sea and the Indian Ocean?

- (A) Palk
- (B) Malacca
- (C) Sunda
- (D) Cook

Solution: Sunda Strait connects the Java Sea and the Indian Ocean and separates Java and Sumatra Island. Malacca Strait connects Andaman sea and south china sea and separates Malay Peninsula and Sumatra Island. Palk strait connects Bay of Bengal and Arabian Sea; Gulf of Mannar separates India and Sri Lanka. Cook Strait connects the Tasman Sea with South Pacific Ocean and separates the North and South Islands of New Zealand.

Q5. Which of the following Indian cities is situated on the banks of Lake Pichola?

- (A) Ahmedabad
- (B) Kurnool
- (C) Udaipur
- (D) Agra

Solution: Udaipur is situated at the banks of Lake Pichola. Pichola Lake was built in 1362 AD by "Banjara" tribesmen. Later, Maharana Udai Singh enlarged the lake by constructing a stone masonry dam in the Badlipol region on the shore of the lake.

Q6. Which of the following pressure belts is known as the horse latitude?

- (A) Equatorial Low Pressure
- (B) Sub-Polar Low Pressure
- (C) High Pressure
- (D) Sub - Tropical High Pressure

Solution: Subtropical high pressure belts (Horse latitude) extend 30° N and 30° S. It is formed because the warm air rising from the equator moves towards the tropics in both hemispheres. Low-pressure belt extends from 0 to 5° North and South. Subpolar low pressure belt extends around latitudes 60° to 65° North and South. High Pressure belts are located at 90° N and 90° S latitudes. There are majorly seven

Pressure Belts on the surface of Earth i.e., the Equatorial Low, two Subtropical Highs, two Subpolar Lows, and two Polar Highs.

Q7. Which river is known as the sorrow of Bihar?

- (A) Mahi
- (B) Kosi
- (C) Son
- (D) Betwa

Solution: Kosi River : It is formed by the Tamur Kosi, originating from the Kanchenjunga area in the east, the Arun River from Tibet, and the Sun Kosi from the Gosainthan area farther west. It joins the Ganges at Kursela in the Katihar district of Bihar. The sorrow of Bengal is the Damodar River. The sorrow of Odisha is the Mahanadi river. The sorrow of Assam is the Brahmaputra river.

Q8. The Green Revolution was due to the introduction of:

- (A) fisheries
- (B) irrigation
- (C) high yielding varieties of seeds
- (D) fertilisers

Solution: high yielding varieties of seeds. Green Revolution : It was a period of significant agricultural advancement in the 1960s and 1970s. It aimed to boost food production through the introduction of high-yielding crop varieties and increased use of chemical fertilizers and pesticides. In India, this agricultural transformation began in the 1960s during the tenure of Prime Minister Lal Bahadur Shastri. The Green Revolution is also referred to as the Third Agricultural Revolution.

Q9. Which among the following is Asia's largest freshwater oxbow lake?

- (A) Wular
- (B) Kanwar
- (C) Bhojtal
- (D) Nakki

Solution: Kanwar. Location - Begusarai, Bihar. India's largest inland salt lake - Sambhar Lake (Rajasthan). India's largest freshwater lake - Wular Lake (Jammu and Kashmir). Largest coastal lagoon in India and first Indian wetland of international importance - Chilika Lake (Odisha). City of Lakes - Udaipur. Land of Thousand Lakes - Finland.

Q10. In which of the following states is Kolleru Lake located?

- (A) Madhya Pradesh
- (B) Kerala
- (C) Andhra Pradesh
- (D) Tamil Nadu

Solution: Kolleru Lake is located in Andhra Pradesh. It is one of the largest freshwater lakes in India.

Q11. Which continent provides more than half of the world's tin?

- (A) Europe
- (B) North Africa
- (C) Asia
- (D) Africa

Solution: Asia. It is the largest (30% of the Earth's land area) and most populous (60% of the total population) continent. Asia is the biggest producer (90% of the world's production) of rice. About 30% of the world's reserves of iron ore are found in Asia. biggest producer of tin - In Asia - China, In India - Chhattisgarh. Europe is the leading producer of iron-ore in the world. North America is the largest producer (25% of the world production) of meat, coal, bauxite, nickel, iron and copper. Africa is the world's largest producer of diamonds, gold and platinum.

Q12. As per the Census-2011, the population growth during the decade remained ____.

- (A) 15.30%
- (B) 14.25%
- (C) 17.64%
- (D) 18.30%

Solution: 17.64%. The Census 2011 is the 15th National census survey conducted by the Census Organization of India. Mr. C. Chandramouli is the Commissioner & Registrar General of the Indian 2011 Census. Top Growth Rated States/UTs: Dadra and Nagar Haveli (55.88%), Daman and Diu (53.76%), Puducherry (28.08%), Meghalaya (27.95%), Arunachal Pradesh (26.03%).

Q13. Which of the following is NOT a tributary of river Kaveri?

- (A) Musi
(B) Bhavani
(C) Hemavati
(D) Kabini

Solution: Musi. Tributaries of river Kaveri: Harangi, Hemavati, Lakshmana Tirtha, Kabini, Suvarnavathi, Shimsha, Arkavati, Sarabanga, Bhavani, Noyyal, Thirumanimutharu, and the Amaravati. Tributaries of river Krishna: Ghataprabha, Malaprabha, Bhima, Tungabhadra and Musi.

Q14. According to the Census of India 2011, which of the following states is the most urbanised?

- (A) Kerala
(B) Goa
(C) Himachal Pradesh
(D) Punjab

Solution: Goa. It has the highest urban population among states, at 62.2%, followed by Kerala at 47.7%. The National Capital Territory of Delhi (97.5%) and Chandigarh (97.25%) are the most urbanized Union Territories. Himachal Pradesh has the lowest urban population, at 10%, followed by Bihar at 11.3%.

Q15. The river Ganga divides the state of Bihar into _____ parts.

- (A) 5
(B) 4
(C) 3
(D) 2

Solution: The river Ganga divides the state of Bihar into three parts. It enters Bihar through Buxar district and exits in Bhagalpur district.

Q16. Which of the following statements regarding ocean currents is correct?

- (A) The Labrador Ocean current is warm current.
(B) The areas where the warm and cold currents meet provide the best fishing grounds.
(C) The cold ocean currents move towards the poles.
(D) The warm ocean currents move towards the equator.

Solution: The areas where the warm and cold currents meet provide the best fishing grounds. Ocean currents are the continuous, predictable, directional movement of seawater driven by gravity, wind (Coriolis Effect), and water density. Largest ocean current on Earth: Antarctic Circumpolar Current (ACC). The Labrador current is a well-known cold ocean current. Warm currents are those that travel from the Equator to the poles and are therefore warmer than the surrounding water.

Q17. Where does the river Brahmaputra originate?

- (A) Glaciers of Mapchachungo
(B) Milam glacier in the Nepal Himalayas
(C) Garhwal hills near Gairsain
(D) Chemayungdung glacier of the Kailash range

Solution: The river Brahmaputra originates from the Chemayungdung glacier of the Kailash range, which covers the slopes of the Himalayas about 60 miles (100 km) southeast of Lake Mapam in southwestern Tibet. The river travels parallel to the eastern Himalayas before entering India through a gorge.

Q18. The Indira Sagar Dam is built over river Narmada in which of the following states of India?

- (A) Karnataka
(B) Gujarat
(C) Madhya Pradesh
(D) Kerala

Solution: Madhya Pradesh. Narmada is also known as the 'lifeline of Madhya Pradesh'. Other Dams in Madhya Pradesh are Gandhi Sagar Dam (Chambal River), Indira Sagar Dam (Narmada River), Omkareshwar Dam (Narmada River), Bansagar Dam (Son River), Madikheda Dam (Sindh River), Tawa Dam (Tawa River).

Q19. Which of the following waterfalls is located in Madhya Pradesh?

- (A) Dhuandhar
(B) Khandadhar
(C) Shivasamudram
(D) Dudhsagar

Solution: Dhuandhar waterfall is located on the Narmada river in Madhya Pradesh. Khandadhar waterfall (Sundargarh district in Odisha), Shivasamudram waterfall (Chamarajanagar district of Karnataka), Dudhsagar waterfall (Mandovi river in Goa).

Q20. _____ species are the species which are not found after searches of known or likely areas where they may occur.

- (A) Extinct
(B) Endangered
(C) Normal
(D) Vulnerable

Solution: Extinct. An endangered species is a type of organism that is threatened by extinction. Examples: Black Rhino, Tiger, Whale, Red Panda, Chimpanzee, Asian Elephant etc. Vulnerable Species that face a high risk of becoming extinct in the wild. Examples: Hippopotamus, Giant Panda, Leatherback Turtle, the Great White Shark etc. Normal Species whose population levels are considered to be normal for their survival. Examples: Cattle, Sal, Pine, Rodents, etc.

Q21. In India, trees of which forest type shed their leaves for about six to eight weeks in dry summer?

- (A) Tropical Deciduous Forests
(B) Tropical Evergreen Forests
(C) Montane Forests
(D) Tropical Thorn Forests and Scrubs

Solution: Tropical Deciduous Forests (monsoon forests). These forests spread over regions which receive rainfall between 70-200 cm. Tendu, palas, amaltas, bel, khair, axlewood, etc. are the common trees of these forests. Tropical Evergreen Forests - These forests are found in the western slope of the Western Ghats, hills of the northeastern region and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands which rainfall above 200 cm and temperature above 22°C. Tropical thorn forests occur in the areas which receive rainfall less than 70 cm. Montane forests are found on mountain slopes and it is a type of mountain ecosystem. It gets affected by colder climate at moderate elevations. In these areas dense forests are common.

Q22. The river Giri is an important tributary of the _____.

- (A) Brahmaputra
(B) Yamuna
(C) Godavari
(D) Cauvery

Solution: The river Giri is an important tributary of the Yamuna. The major tributaries of the Giri River are Ashani which meets Giri close to Chail and Jalal which joins it at Dachau. The Palar and Nait stream meets the river on its left bank.

Q23. Match the following names of primitive forms of cultivation in different states correctly. [Diagram - see online test for image]

- (A) 1-a, 2-b, 3-d, 4-c
(B) 1-b, 2-a, 3-d, 4-c
(C) 1-b, 2-a, 3-c, 4-d
(D) 1-a, 2-b, 3-c, 4-d

Solution: 1-b, 2-a, 3-d, 4-c. Madhya Pradesh: "Bewar" is a form of shifting cultivation practiced by the tribal communities in the state. Andhra Pradesh: "Penda" is a traditional cultivation method commonly used in hilly areas. Odisha: "Bringra" is a primitive form of cultivation used by tribes in forested regions. Jharkhand: "Kuruwa" is associated with tribal groups practicing shifting cultivation in this state.

Q24. Each orbit of the International Space Station (ISS) takes _____ minutes.

- (A) 80 - 82
(B) 85 - 87
(C) 90 - 93
(D) 83 - 86

Solution: 90-93. In 24 hours, the space station makes 16 orbits of Earth, traveling through 16 sunrises and sunsets. A spacecraft can arrive at the space station as soon as four hours after launching from Earth. The space station travels an equivalent distance to the Moon and back in about a day. International Space Station (Orbit height: 408 km, launched date - 20 November 1998, Max speed: 28,000 km/h).

Q25. As per census 2011, what is the position of Uttar Pradesh with respect to the total population of India?

- (A) Fourth
(B) First
(C) Third
(D) Second

Solution: First. Census 2011: Highest Sex Ratio - Kerala (1084), lowest Sex Ratio - Haryana (879), Highest Literacy Rate - Kerala (94.00%), lowest Literacy Rate - Bihar (61.8%), Highest Population - Uttar Pradesh (19.98 Crores) and Density 829 people per sq km, Lowest Population - Sikkim (6.11 Lakhs). Largest States by Area - Rajasthan (342,239 km²). Lowest density - Arunachal Pradesh (17 people per sq km).

Q26. In India, Gir forest is the last remaining habitat of which animal?

- (A) Asiatic Lion

- (B) Snow leopard
(C) Black Panther
(D) Asian Cheetah

Solution: Asiatic Lion. Animals and their Habitat Place - Snow Leopards : Hemis National Park, Gangotri National Park, Khangchendzonga National park. Black Panther - Pench National Park, Bhadra Tiger Reserve. The Asiatic cheetah is a critically endangered cheetah subspecies currently only surviving in Iran.

Q27. Which is the largest part of the northern plains and is formed of older alluvium?

- (A) Terai
(B) Bhabar
(C) **Bhangar**
(D) Khadar

Solution: Bhangar. It is characterized by slightly elevated terraces and is composed of older, more compact sediments compared to the newer and more fertile alluvial deposits found in the Khadar regions. The Bhangar area is less fertile due to the presence of calcareous deposits known as "Kankar."

Q28. In which of the following Indian states will you find the 'Kunchikal Falls'? SSC CGL 18/08/2021(Evening)

- (A) Kerala
(B) **Karnataka**
(C) Tamil Nadu
(D) Telangana

Solution: 'Kunchikal Falls' is formed on Varahi river in Karnataka. It is located in Nidagodu village near Masthikatte in the Shimoga district of Karnataka. The height of this majestic waterfall is 455 mt (1,493 ft) making it the highest waterfall in India.

Q29. Which of the following is a tributary of Indus?

- (A) **Zaskar**
(B) Son
(C) Chambal
(D) Yamuna

Solution: Zaskar. Tributaries of Indus: Left Side - Suru River, Soan River, Panjnad River, Ghaggar-Hakra River (Left), Right Side - Shyok River, Hunza River, Gilgit River, Swat River, Kunar River, Kabul River, Kurram River, Gomal River, Zhob River. Yamuna: Tons, Chambal, Hindon, Betwa and Ken, Son river: Rihand and the North Koel.

Q30. _____ is the highest peak in the Eastern Ghats

- (A) **Mahendragiri**
(B) Khasi
(C) Kanchenjunga
(D) Anai Mudi

Solution: Mahendragiri (1501 m)- Orissa. Kanchenjunga (8,598 m) - Sikkim (third highest mountain in the world and highest mountain peak of the Himalayas, India). Anamudi (2,695 m) - Kerala, (highest mountain peak in Western Ghats and South India). Khasi Hills (1,968 m) - Meghalaya (highest peak is Lum Shyllong).

Q31. Ursa Major is a/an:

- (A) **constellation**
(B) satellite
(C) comet
(D) asteroid

Solution: constellation. Ursa Major or Big Bear is the Saptarishi (Saptaseven, rishi-sages). It is a group of seven stars. Comets: Icy bodies with eccentric orbits around the Sun; Asteroids: Rocky bodies between Mars and Jupiter, remnants of a planet that exploded; Meteoroids: Small rock fragments orbiting the Sun.

Q32. What is the approximate literacy rate of India as per the 2011 census?

- (A) 70.01 percent
(B) 78.2 percent
(C) **74.04 percent**
(D) 83.35 percent

Solution: 74.04 percent (82.14% for males and 65.46% for females). Literacy rate in India : Bihar lowest at 61.8% (Male: 71.20%, Female: 51.50%), Kerala highest at 94% (Male: 96.11%, Female: 92.07%).

Q33. Cultivation of rice needs high rainfall _____ .

- (A) Low temperature and low humidity
(B) High temperature and low humidity
(C) **High temperature and high humidity**
(D) Low temperature and high humidity

Solution: High temperature and high humidity. Fertile riverine alluvial soil is best for rice cultivation. It is a type of Kharif crop. West Bengal is the largest rice-producing state in India. China is the world's largest producer of rice followed by India. Methane is the gas produced by the rice field.

Q34. Yerla, Warna and Dindi are tributaries of the _____ river system.

- (A) Brahmaputra
(B) Godavari
(C) Kaveri
(D) **Krishna**

Solution: Yerla, Warna and Dindi are tributaries of the Krishna river system. Krishna river has a number of tributaries but Tungabhadra is its principal tributary. Other tributaries include the Mallaprabha, Koyna, Bhima, Ghataprabha, Yerla, Warna, Dindi, Musi and Dudhganga. The river drains into the Bay of Bengal at Hamsaladevi.

Q35. The colour of the surface of Mars is red because of the presence of large amounts of chemical compounds in it. What is the name of that compound?

- (A) Magnesium oxide
(B) Tin oxide
(C) **Iron oxide**
(D) Nitrogen oxide

Solution: Iron oxide. Mars appears reddish due to the presence of ferric iron in the form of red hematite (Fe₂O₃). The surface pressure of Mars is 610 Pascals, and its gravity is about one-third of Earth's. A Martian day lasts 24 hours and 37 minutes. Mars has two moons: Phobos and Deimos. The Mars Orbiter Mission (MOM) was launched by the Indian Space Research Organization (ISRO) on 5th November 2013, aboard PSLV C-25, marking India's first interplanetary mission.

Q36. Sex ratio in India is defined as the number of females per _____ .

- (A) 100 males in the population
(B) **1000 males in the population**
(C) 500 males in the population
(D) 100 children in the population

Solution: 1000 males in the population. The Population Census of 2011 revealed that the sex ratio in India was 943 females per 1000 males. Top States with Highest Sex Ratio as per 2011 census - Kerala (1084), Tamil Nadu (996), Andhra Pradesh (993), Chhattisgarh (991). Haryana has the lowest sex ratio (879) in India.

Q37. Which of the following is a vulnerable species?

- (A) Himalayan brown bear
(B) Horn bill
(C) Asiatic cheetah
(D) **Asiatic elephant**

Solution: Asiatic elephant. A vulnerable species is a species which has been categorized by the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) as being threatened with extinction. Some vulnerable species - Great White Shark, Greater One-Horned Rhino, Hippopotamus, Leatherback Turtle, Loggerhead Turtle, Marine Iguana, Olive Ridley Turtle, Polar Bear, Snow Leopard, Southern rockhopper penguin etc.

Q38. According to Census of India 2011, which of the following states recorded the least population?

- (A) Punjab
(B) Tamil Nadu
(C) Gujarat
(D) **Sikkim**

Solution: Sikkim. As per details from Census 2011, Sikkim has a population of 6.11 Lakhs, an increase from the figure of 5.41 Lakh in 2001 census. Total population of Sikkim as per latest census data is 610,577 of which male and female are 323,070 and 287,507 respectively. Uttar Pradesh is the most populated state in India. It holds about 16.50% of India's total population.

Q39. In West Bengal, localised thunderstorms are known as _____ .

- (A) Loo
(B) Chinook
(C) Mango showers
(D) **Kaal Baisakhi**

Solution: Kaal Baisakhi - A localized rainfall and thunderstorm event which occurs in Bangladesh as well as the Indian states of Bihar, Jharkhand, Odisha, Tripura, Assam and West Bengal during Summer. It originated from Chota Nagpur Plateau. It is caused by winds coming from the north-west direction (norwesters). The Loo - a strong, dusty, hot, and

dry summer wind from the west which blows over the Indo-Gangetic Plain region of North India and Pakistan. Chinook - warm, dry wind descending the eastern slopes of the Rocky Mountains, primarily in winter. Mango Showers - Pre-monsoon showers which are common in the states of Karnataka and Kerala.

Q40. Which of the following is NOT a permanent wind?

- (A) Westerlies
- (B) Loo**
- (C) Easterlies
- (D) Trade winds

Solution: Loo - It is hot and dry local wind blows in plains of northern India and Pakistan. Wind is the horizontal movement of air caused by differences in air pressure. It is divided into three types - Permanent winds (Trade winds, Easterlies, Westerlies), Seasonal winds (Land and sea breeze, cyclones, anticyclones, Monsoon etc.) and Local winds (Mistral, sirocco, chinook, Foehn, Kalbaisakhi, Kallandhi etc.).

Q41. Which of the following places is NOT located on the banks of river Ganga?

- (A) Varanasi
- (B) Hazaribagh**
- (C) Kanpur
- (D) Phaphamau

Solution: Hazaribagh is NOT located on the banks of river Ganga. Hazaribagh is a city and a municipal corporation in the Hazaribagh district in Jharkhand. It is the divisional headquarters of the North Chotanagpur division. It is also popular for Hazaribagh Wildlife Sanctuary.

Q42. Generally, in India population census is conducted after how many years?

- (A) 20
- (B) 15
- (C) 10**
- (D) 5

Solution: 10. First Non-synchronous Census- 1872 (Lord Mayo). First Synchronous Census - 1881 (Lord Ripon). First Census Commissioner - W.W. Plauden. First Socio-Economic and Caste Census (SECC) - 1931. Census (7th schedule) is conducted under provisions of the Census Act (1948) piloted by Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel.

Q43. Which of the following statements about climate is INCORRECT?

- (A) India's climate has characteristics of tropical as well as subtropical climates.
- (B) Coastal areas of India experience less contrasts in temperature conditions as compared to the interior of the country.
- (C) 'Monsoon' type of climate is found mainly in south and southeast Asia.
- (D) India experiences comparatively stronger winters as compared to central Asia.**

Solution: Central Asia generally experiences stronger winters compared to India due to its continental location and lack of moderating influences like large bodies of water. The climate of India is the tropical monsoon climate type with regional variations in temperature, precipitation, and amount of rainfall because of the large geographical area.

Q44. In which of the following decades, there was a negative growth rate in the Indian population?

- (A) 1911-1921**
- (B) 1941-1951
- (C) 1961-1971
- (D) 1921-1931

Solution: 1911-1921. Decadal Growth Rates in India: Census year (% of Growth) - 1911 (+ 5.75), 1921 (- 0.31). Percentage growth in 2001-2011 is 17.64%; males 17.19% and females 18.12%. Population growth during this period can be termed as stagnant. The high birth rate was balanced by high death rates during this period. The high mortality during this period was the result of large scale deaths due to epidemics of influenza, plague, smallpox, cholera, etc.

Q45. Which of the following is not an important river of Malwa plateau?

- (A) Chambal river
- (B) Mahanadi river**
- (C) Ken river
- (D) Betwa river

Solution: Mahanadi. This river rises from a place in Sihawa, near Raipur in the state of Chhattisgarh to the south of Amarkantak and the river flows through the states of Chhattisgarh and Odisha before finally ending in the Bay of Bengal. It is also known for the Hirakud Dam. River of

Malwa plateau - Mahi River, Ken rivers, Shipra River, Chambal River, Betwa River.

Q46. "Agricultural Census" is conducted in India at an interval of _____.

- (A) six years
- (B) five years**
- (C) four years
- (D) ten years

Solution: Five years. "The Eleventh Agricultural Census" (2021-22) - launched by The Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers' Welfare. Aim - Focus of the census is on increasing the income of the farmers and empowering them by organizing small farmers. Agriculture Census Scheme has been undertaken by the Agriculture Ministry since 1970-71. Agriculture Census - Conducted in India on the basis of guidelines of decennial World Census of Agriculture (WCA). It is formulated by the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) of the United Nations.

Q47. Which of the following rivers empties into the Gulf of Cambay of the Arabian Sea, in the state of Gujarat?

- (A) Krishna
- (B) Godavari
- (C) Tapti**
- (D) Cauvery

Solution: Tapti river empties into the Gulf of Cambay of the Arabian Sea, in the state of Gujarat. It is a river in central India located to the south of the Narmada river which flows westwards before draining into the Arabian Sea. The river has a length of around 700km and flows through the states of Maharashtra, Gujarat, and Madhya Pradesh.

Q48. What is the zone between the arctic circle and north pole called?

- (A) Torrid zone
- (B) Frigid zone**
- (C) North temperate zone
- (D) South temperate zone

Solution: Frigid zone. The North Frigid Zone, between the North Pole at 90° N and the Arctic Circle at 66° 33' 48.7" N, covers 4.12% of Earth's surface. The torrid zone refers to the area of the earth between the Tropic of Cancer and the Tropic of Capricorn. The north temperate zone is located between the Arctic Circle at 66° 33' N and the Tropic of Cancer at 23° 27' N. The south temperate zone is located between the Tropic of Capricorn at 23° 27' S and the Antarctic Circle at 66° 33' S.

Q49. The largest inland salt lake 'Sambhar' is located in the _____ of India.

- (A) north-east
- (B) north-west**
- (C) south-west
- (D) south-east

Solution: north-west. Sambhar Salt Lake (located in Rajasthan) spans 230 square kilometers. It is a significant depression in the Aravalli Range and is commonly referred to as the salt lake of Rajasthan. The lake receives water from six rivers: Mantha, Rupangarh, Khari, Khandela, Medtha and Samod.

Q50. Which union Territory of India lies in the Bay of Bengal?

- (A) Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu
- (B) Chandigarh
- (C) Lakshadweep Islands
- (D) Andaman and Nicobar Islands**

Solution: Andaman and Nicobar Islands are separated by the Ten Degree Channel. Capital - Port Blair (South Andaman), Highest Peak - Saddle Peak (732 m) (North Andaman). Tribes: Sentinelese, Shompen. Barren Island is the only active volcano in India. Duncan passage separates Little Andaman from South Andaman. Ross Island (South Andaman) has been renamed as Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose Dweep, Neil Island as Shaheed Dweep, and Havelock Island as Swaraj Dweep.

Q51. Cultivation of wheat thrives best in which type of soil?

- (A) Yellow soil
- (B) Red soil
- (C) Black soil
- (D) Well drained loamy soil**

Solution: Well drained loamy soil. It is composed of sand, silt and clay. Some Loamy soil Crops: Sugarcane, pulses, vegetables and oilseeds. Red & Yellow soil crops: maize/corn, groundnut, ragi (finger millet) and potato. Black soil crops: cotton, jowar, linseed, Virginia tobacco, castor, sunflower, and millets.

Q52. Which of the following is termed as "sericulture"?

- (A) Cultivation of grapes
- (B) Growing of fruits
- (C) Breeding of fish
- (D) Commercial rearing of silk worms**

Solution: Commercial rearing of silkworms. 'Bombyx mori', 'Eri', 'Muga' and 'Tasar' are silkworm species used in sericulture. These are used to produce silk fiber (protein) from their silk glands. Moriculture refers to the cultivation of mulberry plants. Other types of farming : Horticulture - fruits or vegetables. Aviculture - Bird. Apiculture - Bee. Pisciculture - fish. Viticulture - Grapes. Fungiculture - mushroom. Arboriculture - tree. Silviculture - fodder crops. Olericulture - vegetables.

Q53. Which of the following is NOT a traditional water storage structure?

- (A) Johad
- (B) Kund
- (C) Tanka
- (D) Haryali**

Solution: Haryali is NOT a traditional water storage structure. The other three structures Johad, Kund and Tanka are traditional ways of water storage. Haryali is a watershed development project with an aim to ensure the overall development of rural areas through the gram panchayats and create regular sources of income for the panchayats from the rainwater harvesting and management.

Q54. The area served by a canal system through the supply of water for irrigation and other purposes is called a ____.

- (A) command area**
- (B) net sown area
- (C) net irrigated area
- (D) gross irrigated area

Solution: The area served by a canal system through the supply of water for irrigation and other purposes is called a command area. It is the total area that can be economically irrigated from an irrigation scheme without considering the limitations of water. It includes cultivable land, roads, wastelands, forests, barren lands.

Q55. Tropical grasslands of Brazil are known as ____.

- (A) Pampas
- (B) Savanna
- (C) Llanos
- (D) Campos**

Solution: Campos. Pampas grasslands are situated in Argentina. The tropical grasslands in Africa are known as savannah. Tropical grasslands are known as Llanos in Venezuela and savanna in East Africa. Other grasslands of the world- Pampas: Argentina and Uruguay. Eurasian Steppe: Russia, Kazakhstan, Mongolia, and Ukraine. Australian Rangelands: Australia. Veld: South Africa. Serengeti-Mara Grassland: Tanzania and Kenya. Chaco: Paraguay, Argentina, and Bolivia.

Q56. Which among the following lakes is known as the only "Floating islands Lake" in India?

- (A) Loktak**
- (B) Pulicat
- (C) Chilka
- (D) Kolleru

Solution: Loktak lake (Manipur). Chilka Lake (Odisha) is the largest brackish water lake in Asia. The lake was formed due to the silting action of the Mahanadi River which drains into the northern end of the lake. Kolleru Lake (located between Krishna and Godavari deltas) is the largest freshwater lake in Andhra Pradesh. Pulicat Lake is the second largest brackish water lagoon in India. Major part of the lagoon comes under Tirupati district of Andhra Pradesh.

Q57. Andaman Islands and Nicobar islands are separated by a water body which is called the ____.

- (A) Conolly Canal
- (B) Palk Strait
- (C) Ten Degree Channel**
- (D) Gulf of Mannar

Solution: Ten Degree Channel. The Gulf of Mannar - A part of the Laccadive Sea in the Indian Ocean. Palk Strait - Between TamilNadu and the Mannar district of the Northern Province of Sri Lanka. Duncan Passage - It separates Rutland Island to the north, and Little Andaman to the south. Minicoy and Maldives (8° channel). Minicoy and Lakshadweep (9° channel). Conolly Canal (West coast canal network of Kerala, Kozhikode to Kochi).

Q58. The Green Revolution led to an increase in the agricultural output primarily due to the use of HYV seeds. Here, HYV refers to:

- (A) Heat Yielding Variant
- (B) High Yield Variant

- (C) High Yielding Variance
- (D) High Yielding Variety**

Solution: High Yielding Variety. HYV seeds are known for their resistance to pests and diseases and their high yield potential. The Green Revolution in India, spanning from the 1960s to the 1980s, greatly increased food production through the widespread use of these seeds, resulting in a grain output of 131 million tonnes in 1978-79.

Q59. India is the _____ producer of pulses and the _____ consumer of pulses.

- (A) second largest, second largest
- (B) largest, second largest
- (C) second largest, largest
- (D) largest, largest**

Solution: largest, largest. India is the largest producer (25% of global production), consumer (27% of world consumption) and importer (14%) of pulses in the world. Highest Pulse producing state in India - Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, Maharashtra, Uttar Pradesh, respectively. 2016 as the International Year of Pulses (IYP) marked by the United Nation. World Pulses Day - 10 February.

Q60. When a river originates from a hill and flows in all directions, the drainage pattern is known as ____.

- (A) centripetal
- (B) trellis
- (C) dendritic
- (D) radial**

Solution: When a river originates from a hill and flows in all directions, it is known as a radial pattern. Other types of drainage patterns are- Centripetal- when rivers discharge their waters from all directions into a depression. Eg. Loktak lake in Manipur. Trellis- when the primary tributaries of main rivers flow parallel to each other and secondary tributaries join them at right angles. Dendritic-looks like the branching pattern of tree roots.

Q61. When the grains of sand are very fine and light, the wind can carry it over a very long distance. When such sand is deposited in large areas, it is called ____.

- (A) loess**
- (B) moraines
- (C) mushroom
- (D) stacks

Solution: Loess. It is a clastic, predominantly silt-sized sediment that is formed by the accumulation of wind-blown dust. Moraine- It is a material left behind by a moving glacier. There are mainly 4 types of moraines - lateral moraines, ground moraines, medial moraines, and terminal moraines. Stack- It is a geological landform consisting of a steep and often vertical column or columns of rock in the sea near a coast, formed by wave erosion. A mushroom is the reproductive structure produced by some fungi.

Q62. According to Census of India 2011, what was the sex ratio recorded in the Union Territory of Puducherry?

- (A) 890 females/1000 males
- (B) 980 females/1000 males
- (C) 1037 females/1000 males**
- (D) 1095 females/1000 males

Solution: 1037 females/1000 males. According to the Census, the sex ratio in India has increased from 933 females per 1,000 males in 2001 to 943 females per 1,000 males in 2011, with Kerala recording the highest sex ratio at 1,084 and Haryana recording the lowest sex ratio among states at 879, while Delhi had the lowest sex ratio among Union Territories at 868.

Q63. The asteroid belt lies between which two planets ?

- (A) Jupiter and Saturn
- (B) Mars and Jupiter**
- (C) Saturn and Uranus
- (D) Mercury and Venus

Solution: 15. (b) Mars and Jupiter. Asteroid Belt separates the inner and outer planets. Jupiter and Saturn, Uranus and Neptune are the Outer planets (Last four from the Sun) and also known as Jovian Planets. The first four planets (Mercury, Venus, Earth and Mars) are known as Inner or Terrestrial planets.

Q64. The Deccan Plateau is a _____ landmass that lies to the south of the river Narmada.

- (A) rectangular
- (B) quadrilateral
- (C) triangular**
- (D) hexagonal

Solution: triangular. The Deccan Plateau is a triangular landmass, higher in the west and sloping gently eastwards. It extends into the northeast as the Meghalaya, Karbi-Anglong, and North Cachar Hills and is separated from the Chotanagpur Plateau by a fault. The Western Ghats and Eastern Ghats mark its western and eastern edges, respectively.

Q65. The Arctic Ocean is located within the Arctic Circle and surrounds the North Pole. It is connected with the Pacific Ocean by a narrow stretch of shallow water known as

- (A) Berring
(B) Palk
(C) Hudson
(D) Bosphorus

Solution: Berring. Bosphorus strait is a natural strait, located in northwestern Turkey, connecting the Black Sea to the Sea of Marmara. Hudson Strait links the northern seaports of Manitoba and Ontario with the Atlantic Ocean. Palk Strait is a strait between India and Sri Lanka. It connects the Bay of Bengal in the northeast with the Gulf of Mannar in the southwest.

Q66. Which of the following statements is NOT correct?

- (A) Mahendragiri is the highest peak in the Eastern Ghats.
(B) The height of the Western Ghats progressively decreases from north to south.
(C) The Western Ghats cause orographic rain.
(D) The Eastern Ghats stretch from the Mahanadi Valley to the Nilgiris in the south.

Solution: Option (b) is not correct. The height of the Western Ghats progressively increases from north to south. The highest peaks of Western Ghats include the Anai Mudi (2,695 metres) and the Doda Betta (2,637 metres). The Western Ghats, also known as the Sahyadri Hills, mainly traverse the States of Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Goa, Maharashtra and Gujarat.

Q67. According to 2011 Census, among the following which state has the lowest sex ratio?

- (A) Haryana
(B) Bihar
(C) Sikkim
(D) Jharkhand

Solution: Haryana (879/1000). Sex Ratio - The number of females per thousand male. The Decadal Census is conducted by the Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India (Ministry of Home Affairs). The highest sex ratio is in Kerala (1084). Among UTs Puducherry (1038) has the highest, And Daman and Diu (618) has lowest. Overall sex ratio for India is 943.

Q68. In India, what is the mean annual average temperature in subtropical vegetation zone?

- (A) Above 24° C
(B) 7° C to 17° C
(C) Below 7° C
(D) 17° C to 24° C

Solution: 17° C to 24° C. Natural vegetation - The plant life that grows in an area without the influence of human activity. Types - Forests, Grasslands (divided into savannas, steppes and prairies, depending on the climate and other environmental factors), Deserts (These are arid regions with very little rainfall and sparse vegetation), Tundra (This is a cold, treeless region found in the Arctic and on high mountain slopes), Wetland (These are areas with water-logged soil, such as marshes).

Q69. National Waterway 2 (NW 2) is the Sadiya-Dhubri stretch of the _____ river.

- (A) Brahmaputra
(B) Ganga
(C) Son
(D) Krishna

Solution: Brahmaputra. The Sadiya-Dhubri stretch of the Brahmaputra river (891 Km) - declared as National Waterway-2 in 1988, located in Assam. 111 waterways (including 5 existing and 106 new) - declared as NWs by the National Waterways Act, 2016. National Waterway 1 (1620 kms): Ganga-Bhagirathi - Hooghly River System (Haldia - Allahabad), National Waterway No 3 is a 205 km long inland navigational route

located in Kerala, India, which runs from Kollam to Kottapuram.

Q70. Where is the Jai Hind bridge located in India?

- (A) Kolkata
(B) Hyderabad
(C) Mumbai
(D) Chennai

Solution: Kolkata's Majerhat Bridge Named "Jai Hind" To Mark Subhas Chandra Bose's 125th Birth Anniversary

Q71. Which of the following statements regarding river Ganga is correct?

- (A) Ghaghara is a tributary coming from peninsular uplands.
(B) Yamuna is a right bank tributary meets the Ganga at Allahabad.
(C) The length of the Ganga is over 5000 km.
(D) Betwa is a tributary of river Ganga rising from the Himalayas.

Solution: Yamuna is a right bank tributary that meets the Ganga at Allahabad. Ganga originates from the Gangotri glacier in the Western Himalayan Range in Uttarakhand. Tributaries: Left (Ramganga, Garra, Gomti, Ghaghara, Gandak, Burhi Gandak, Koshi, Mahananda, Brahmaputra, Meghna), Right (Yamuna, Tamsa, Karamnasa, Sone, Punpun, Falgu, Kiul, Chandan, Ajoy, Damodar, Rupnarayan).

Q72. The main mineral constituents of the continental mass are _____ and _____.

- (A) silica, magnesium
(B) silica, alumina
(C) oxygen, carbon
(D) alumina, magnesium

Solution: Silica, alumina. It is often termed as SIAL (SI-silica and AL - aluminium). Earth (three layers): Crust, Mantle, and Core. Crust (outermost) - It is about 8 km thick under the oceans and about 32 km thick under the continents. Mantle - The major constituent elements are silicon and Magnesium. Core (mostly Iron and nickel) - This is the innermost layer of the earth.

Q73. According to census 2011, which is the second largest religious minority of India?

- (A) Christians
(B) Buddhist
(C) Sikhs
(D) Muslim

Solution: Christians. As per Census 2011 - Total Population in 2011 was 121.09 crores. Hindu 96.63 crores (79.8%); Muslim 17.22 crores (14.2%); Christian 2.78 crores (2.3%); Sikh 2.08 crores (1.7%); Buddhist 0.84 crores (0.7%); Jain 0.45 crores (0.4%); Other Religions & Persuasions (ORP) 0.79 crores (0.7%) and Religion Not Stated 0.29 crores (0.2%). Article 29 and 30 - Cultural And Educational Rights for Minorities in India.

Q74. A/an _____ is a natural geo-hydrological unit of land, which collects water and drains it through a common point by a system of streams.

- (A) warabandi
(B) aquifer
(C) watershed
(D) reservoir

Solution: A watershed is a natural geo-hydrological unit of land that drains all the streams and rainfall to a common outlet such as the outflow of a reservoir, mouth of a bay, or any point along a stream channel.

Q75. How many censuses had been completed in India as of year 2011?

- (A) 15
(B) 7
(C) 12
(D) 16

Solution: 15. Census 2011, the 7th after independence, had the slogan "Our Census, Our Future." India was the first country in the world to adopt a family planning program. The first census in India was conducted in 1872 AD under Lord Mayo, while the first official synchronized census was carried out in 1881 AD under Lord Ripon. Since 1901, the census has been conducted every decade.